Mike Corcoran

Creative Technologist and AI Production Architect

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PROFILE

Creative technologist and production architect with 30 years in film and VFX at ILM, Weta Digital, DreamWorks, and DNEG. Founder of And Action!, a generative AI production platform in private beta. Combines hands-on creative craft and software development with experience deploying workflows across studios, helping artists adopt new tools, and building a character effects department to more than 30 artists.

CORE EXPERTISE

Generative AI workflows and model evaluation | Production architecture | Prototyping and API integration | Workflow deployment and adoption | Creative and technical leadership

EXPERIENCE

And Action!
Founder | Jul 2025 - Present

- Took a film production platform from concept to live private beta as sole product owner and engineer, using AI-assisted development. Patent application pending.
- Connected model-agnostic canvas workflows, an AI agent, versioned assets and takes, review, and timeline editing in one production environment.
- Designed project membership and role-based permissions governing what each person can view, edit, or manage, including read-only access to selected media and reviews for clients.
- Built a shared canvas for real-time team collaboration and preserved the workflow graph and parameters behind each take so results can be reconstructed, revised, and handed off.
- Integrated generative model APIs and evaluated creative control, cost, latency, and reliability. Built with React, TypeScript, Python, FastAPI, and PostgreSQL.

DNEG
Principal Solutions Architect and Head of Research, Creature Technology | Sep 2022 - Jul 2025

- Directed character technology R&D across rigging, animation, facial performance, and simulation for studios in Vancouver, London, and Mumbai.
- Led AI and machine learning integration strategy, evaluating and deploying AI-assisted tools, procedural rigging frameworks, and performance-driven simulation methods.
- Partnered with R&D and production supervisors to identify workflow bottlenecks and prototype solutions for creative control, efficiency, and scalability.

DNEG
Global Workflow Architect, Creatures | Feb 2021 - May 2022

- Led design and global deployment of standardized creature workflows; drove adoption of USD-based pipeline unification across studio locations.
- Developed cross-site approaches to rigging, simulation, and asset management with engineering, R&D, and department leads, streamlining interdepartmental data flow.

EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Versatile Media

Head of Research and Development | Jan 2020 - Jan 2021

- Joined as the first R&D hire to establish the team, strategy, and technical foundation for a virtual production character pipeline.
- Recruited and managed developers and artists; led research into facial performance for real-time applications.

Industrial Light & Magic

Senior and Lead Creature Technical Director | Jul 2016 - Jan 2020

- Built hero character rigs and delivered shot simulation and corrective shapes, collaborating across production departments and often serving as sole or lead artist during early production.

Selected credits: Black Panther (Creature Supervisor), Thor: Ragnarok, Aquaman, Solo: A Star Wars Story, Kong: Skull Island, Terminator: Dark Fate.

Weta Digital

Lead Creature Technical Director and Lighting Technical Director | Jun 2010 - Jun 2014

- Developed hero character simulation rigs and delivered hair, cloth, simulation, and lighting work across feature productions in collaboration with other departments.

Selected credits: Rise of the Planet of the Apes, Dawn of the Planet of the Apes, The Avengers, Prometheus, The Adventures of Tintin, The Hobbit: The Desolation of Smaug.

ImageMovers Digital

Head of Character Effects | May 2007 - Jun 2010

- Built the department from its first CFX artist to a team of 30+; led hiring, mentoring, dailies, shot and bid reviews, and production delivery on A Christmas Carol.
- Defined the CFX pipeline, simulation approach, grooming standards, and garment workflows; coordinated with animation, rigging, FX, lighting, and compositing.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Industrial Light & Magic: Senior Lighting Technical Director (2016); Creature Technical Director (2006-2007); Creature Developer (1995-2000). Weta Digital: Creature Technical Director (2004-2005). DreamWorks: Effects Animator and Character Technical Director (2003-2004). Freelance Programmer (2000-2003).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Development: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, FastAPI, REST APIs, PostgreSQL, Git, GitHub, Linux, AI-assisted software development.

Creative production: Maya (deep expertise), Houdini (working proficiency), Nuke, Katana, USD, ShotGrid, Jira; character rigging, simulation, lighting, and production pipelines.

AI and workflows: Generative image and video models, API orchestration, agent workflows, MCP, model evaluation, provenance, asset versioning, collaboration, and access permissions.

EDUCATION AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

University of California, Berkeley: BA, Philosophy. California State University, Sacramento: Computer Science studies.

Stanford University Online: Product Management (XPROD110); User Research (XPROD115). NVIDIA Deep Learning Institute: Develop, Customize, and Publish in Omniverse With Extensions.